Contents

Foreword xiii

Acknowledgments xv

Introduction xvii

Part I — Metaprogramming Ruby

1. **The M Word** 3
   - Ghost Towns and Marketplaces 3
   - The Story of Bob, Metaprogrammer 4
   - Metaprogramming and Ruby 7

2. **Monday: The Object Model** 11
   - Open Classes 11
   - Inside the Object Model 16
   - Quiz: Missing Lines 26
   - What Happens When You Call a Method? 27
   - Quiz: Tangle of Modules 39
   - Wrap-Up 42

3. **Tuesday: Methods** 45
   - A Duplication Problem 46
   - Dynamic Methods 48
   - method_missing 55
   - Quiz: Bug Hunt 64
   - Blank Slates 66
   - Wrap-Up 69

4. **Wednesday: Blocks** 73
   - The Day of the Blocks 73
   - Quiz: Ruby# 75